

forward, liquid cooling will not be limited to GPUs. As CPUs become more powerful and run AI and general-purpose workloads, they too will require liquid cooling, making talent development critical across data centre infrastructure.

Q. How do you see AI chip competition evolving beyond NVIDIA? Any early bets on challengers?

A. There is clearly a race underway among the large global players, and it's something to watch unfold. They have the capital and talent to experiment at scale. Beyond them, several startups such as those building inference-specific accelerators are trying to compete, but they face a fundamental challenge: volume. While their hardware can technically match GPUs for inference, low production volumes make it hard to achieve competitive pricing, which is critical in the electronics industry.

My view is that many of these players may ultimately be overtaken by CPUs. CPU vendors are steadily embedding deep-learning capabilities, similar in concept to those of TPUs today. Most enterprise AI workloads run on relatively modest models, often one to two billion parameters which already perform well on CPUs. Over the next two to three years, general-purpose inference is likely to shift largely to CPUs, while large-scale training will continue to rely on GPUs and a small number of specialised accelerators.

Q. Why is sovereignty so important to you, especially in AI?

A. It's both personal and strategic. Early in my career, I realised that world-class opportunities could be created in India, I didn't need to leave the country to succeed. That shaped my belief that India can and should build its own technology capabilities. Later, seeing how much personal data global platforms collect tracking behaviour, location, and usage highlighted serious privacy and control concerns. As AI becomes more powerful, this concentration of data and capability becomes even more critical. For me, sovereignty means building strong, capable technology in India that protects data, serves local needs, and gives us control over critical systems. It has never limited us; it has enabled everything we've built.

Q. What are your views on India building its own foundational AI models?

A. India's AI mission is a well-thought-out and timely step, and it's still too early to judge outcomes. India should absolutely build its own AI models, but not by reinventing the wheel. The real gap isn't just

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